

Daily Economic Briefing

Edition 16 | Tuesday 8 September 2026 | Published approx. 00:15 UTC 8 Sept 2026
Cutoff: approx. 20:09 ET Monday 7 September 2026 | Window: since edition 15 (approx. 00:20 UTC 7 Sept)
US Labor Day holiday edition -- no Monday trading session; covers the holiday period and previews Tuesday's reopen

Edition notes: (1) **Scheduler healthy, 9th consecutive clean fire** (last_fired_at 2026-09-08T00:08:41Z, approx. 8 min after the 00:00 UTC slot; no duplicate, no gap). (2) **Fed Chair Kevin Warsh confirmed** via federalreserve.gov Board bio page -- unchanged.^[1] (3) **Bitcoin Thursday-close discrepancy (editions 14-15): RESOLVED.** Fortune's \$77,934 was an 8am ET snapshot; BTC rallied approx. 5% intraday to close approx. \$81,264 by 8pm ET^[2] -- no conflict with edition 14's logged approx. \$81,200-81,600. (4) **Planet Labs Friday close (edition 15 open thread): RESOLVED** at \$18.11 (-1.28%).^[3] (5) **Copper ATH:** unchanged at \$6.7270/lb (25 Aug 2026) per edition 15's multi-source resolution; Trading Economics still reports \$6.83 but the three independent corroborating sources from edition 15 remain the stronger evidence. (6) **Trigger stored prompt:** still contains retired Step 5 GitHub/Telegram language (now 10 editions, 7-16); continuing to hold per edition 9's judgment.

- 60-second read**
- Iran-Hormuz tanker war intensified sharply over the weekend:** Iran fired anti-ship ballistic missiles at two US warships (a first); US struck and disabled three Iranian oil tankers in retaliation; Iran threatened a new maritime "restricted zone" near the Strait -- Brent \$97.02 (+0.76%),^[4] WTI \$92.63 (+1.25%),^[5] US diesel hit a new all-time record of \$5.90/gal,^[6] tanker traffic fell to 10 vessels/day from 15+.^[7]
 - Canada's approx. \$27.6bn retaliatory tariffs take effect at 12:01am Tuesday** on 700+ US products across three tiers (steel/aluminum 50%, dairy/appliances 25%, electronics 15%) -- the first trading session with them live.^[8]
 - CPI week:** PPI Thursday, CPI Friday -- now widely seen as the casting vote for the coin-flip 16 Sept FOMC; rate-hike odds essentially split across venues (Kalshi 50.5% hike, Polymarket 48.5% hike);^[9] FOMC blackout began 5 Sept.^[10]
 - Heavy earnings week:** GameStop Tuesday AH, Apple iPhone 18 event Wednesday (first under CEO John Ternus), Oracle Thursday AH (options imply +/-11.2%),^[11] Adobe Thursday AH, Kroger Friday; Goldman Sachs Communacopia tech conference runs all week with Nvidia, AMD, Broadcom presenting.^[12]
 - VIX at 14.53, its 7th consecutive weekly decline** -- dealers are long gamma with the flip zone at approx. 7,637-7,723,^[13] but approx. \$6.2 trillion in options expires through the 18 Sept triple witching,^[14] threatening to dissolve the vol-suppression regime heading into FOMC.

1 Market recap

US equity markets were closed Monday for Labor Day. S&P 500 futures traded flat at approx. 7,722 on Globex, essentially unchanged from Friday's cash close of 7,718.60;^[15] Nasdaq 100 futures held approx. 29,565, just below a breakout level at 29,600.^[15] Bond markets were also closed; the last traded 10-year yield was 4.78-4.79% and the 2-year 4.37%, both post-payrolls Friday levels.^[16] Asian markets traded on Monday: Nikkei +2% above 66,300, Kospi +3.9%, Hang Seng -1%.^[17]

2 Equities and earnings

Weekend / holiday corporate news for Tuesday's reopen

- Anthropic IPO delayed to mid-October** (from early September); expected valuation approx. \$2 trillion; run-rate revenue above \$47bn; finalizing approx. \$15bn revolving credit facility led by Morgan Stanley.^[18]
- Google adtech antitrust ruling:** Judge Brinkema rejected DOJ's breakup request for the AdX exchange, accepted behavioral remedies instead (real-time bid access to competitors); GOOG rose 0.6% on the ruling -- third consecutive failed Big Tech breakup attempt by US antitrust enforcers.^[19]
- Nvidia-HuggingFace:** SEC filing details approx. \$12.9bn total (\$11.9bn to shareholders + \$1.0bn equity retention); expected close H1 2027; Needham maintained Buy/\$300, Raymond James Strong Buy ("controlling a critical entry point in the AI model ecosystem").^[20]
- Lululemon:** new CEO Heidi O'Neill (ex-Nike) starts Tue 9 Sept; analyst consensus has collapsed to 1 buy / 29 holds / 4 sells, mean PT down from \$291 to \$125 over 12 months; leggings sales fell approx. 20% in Q2, market share contracted 10pp to 43.9%.^[21]
- Tesla / Cybercab:** NHTSA opened a probe Friday into whether Tesla properly self-certified the Cybercab (no steering wheel, pedals, or mirrors); RBC said the Austin launch "left core questions unanswered" on pricing, production timelines, and regulatory status.^[22]
- FICO / VantageScore:** FHFA ordered Fannie/Freddie to accept VantageScore 4.0 from all lenders, effective immediately, ending FICO's mortgage-scoring monopoly; FICO charges \$10+/score vs VantageScore sub-\$1; mortgage origination revenue is 62% of FICO's Scores segment.^[23]
- Other M&A:** Flex acquiring EPC Power for \$4.4bn (AI data center power conversion); SoundHound completed LivePerson acquisition (\$43M); BMO completed sale of 138 US branches to First Citizens Bank.^[24]

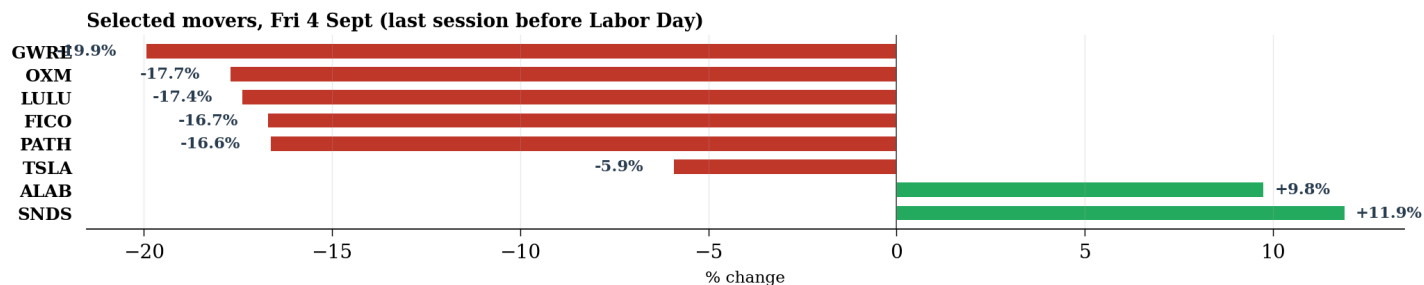
Earnings calendar this week

Date	Before open	After close / Event
Tue 8 Sept	ABM Industries, United Natural Foods	GameStop (prelim Q2: net sales \$780-800M, net income \$290-310M incl. \$238M eBay gains, \$5.05-5.07B cash, \$2B buyback auth.) ^[25] ; Braze, Casey's General, ServiceTitan
Wed 9 Sept	Academy Sports, Chewy, Jersey Mike's, Korn/Ferry, SailPoint, Signet	Apple iPhone 18 event (first under CEO John Ternus; expected: iPhone 18 Pro/Pro Max, first foldable iPhone, Siri AI with 2nm A20 Pro chip) ^[26] ; American Eagle, AeroVironment
Thu 10 Sept	Macy's	Oracle Q1 FY27 (cons. EPS \$1.72, rev \$19.14B +28% y/y; beat 3 of last 4 qtrs; options imply +/-11.2% vs 16.1% avg last 4) ^[11] ; Adobe (EPS \$6.08)
Fri 11 Sept	Kroger (EPS \$1.06, rev \$34.61B)	--

Analyst actions (Fri 4 Sept post-close and Mon 7 Sept pre-market)

Name	Firm	Action	Detail
Shell (SHEL)	Morgan Stanley	Upgrade	EW to OW, PT \$101.30
TotalEnergies (TTE)	Morgan Stanley	Downgrade	OW to EW, PT \$90
UiPath (PATH)	Canaccord	Downgrade	Buy to Hold, PT \$17 (Salesforce-Anthropic threat)
Palo Alto (PANW)	PhillipCapital	Downgrade	Accumulate to Neutral
Alibaba (BABA)	Bernstein SocGen	PT cut	\$180 to \$165
PulteGroup (PHM)	StoneX	Initiate	Buy, PT \$148

Goldman Sachs Communacopia + Technology Conference runs all week with Nvidia, AMD, AT&T, Broadcom, Cloudflare, Zillow, and Lumen presenting.^[12] Also this week: Barclays Global Consumer, Citigroup TMT, DA Davidson Big Sky Tech.



3 Macro, policy and rates

FOMC blackout began Saturday 5 September and runs through Thursday 17 September.^[10] The last pre-blackout Fed commentary: Gov. Waller (3 Sept) signaled a conditional hold but said "it may be appropriate to raise the policy rate" if August inflation disappoints;^[27] Chair Warsh's Jackson Hole keynote (28 Aug) remains the anchor -- hawkish, with PCE at 3.7% and "we have work to do."^[28] President Trump posted on Truth Social on 4 September: "LOWER THE RATE OR I'LL STOP TRADING WITH COUNTRIES WITH WHICH WE HAVE A DEFICIT" -- explicitly linking trade policy to monetary decisions for the first time.^[29]

Rate odds are a genuine coin-flip heading into CPI week: Kalshi 50.5% hike / 48.5% hold; Polymarket 48.5% hike / 51.5% hold; futures-implied measures ran 55-63% hike at Friday's close, but those were priced before the long weekend.^[9] JP Morgan's base case is a 25bp hike (approx. 65% probability), citing Hormuz supply disruptions.^[30]

Global central banks this week: ECB expected to hike 25bp Thursday (deposit rate above 2.25%);^[31] BOJ rate hike increasingly likely at its 17-18 Sept meeting (to 1.25% from 1.00%), carrying outsized USD/JPY importance.^[31]

Treasuries (last trade, Fri 4 Sept): 10Y 4.78-4.79%, 2Y 4.37%, 30Y 5.24-5.25% -- all post-payrolls levels; next H.15 data posts Tuesday.^[16] Fed funds effective rate: 3.63%.^[32]

4 Commodities and FX

Oil: The weekend Iran escalation (see 60-second read) pushed Brent to \$97.02 (+0.76%) and WTI to \$92.63 (+1.25%) on Monday's Globex session,^{[4][5]} both extending from Friday's already-elevated closes. Brent touched \$97.50 intraday, a fresh 6-week high.^[4] CENTCOM Adm. Brad Cooper: "If you shoot at two of our ships, we will impose an even higher economic cost -- taking out three of yours."^[33] Iran's Parliament Speaker Qalibaf declared "any attack against Iran's interests will receive a faster, heavier and more painful response."^[34] Tanker traffic through the Strait fell to just 10 vessels/day, down from 15+.^[7] US diesel hit a new all-time record of \$5.9015/gal; regular gasoline averaged \$4.15/gal nationally, with California at \$5.81.^[6] Natural gas: \$2.97/MMBtu (-0.22%).^[35]

Gold / silver: Gold fell to \$4,391.76 (-1.9% from Friday's \$4,476.60) -- rate-hike expectations are winning the tug-of-war against safe-haven demand from Iran escalation.^[36] Silver \$65.90 (-1.3%).^[37]

Copper: \$6.55-6.57/lb (-0.47-0.57%), well off the 2026 ATH of \$6.7270 (25 Aug).^[38]

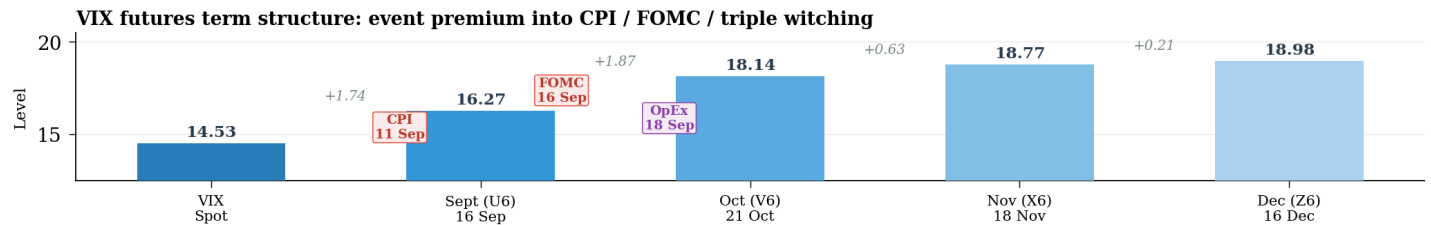
FX: DXY approx. 98.90 (-0.28%), giving back some of Friday's payrolls-driven strength.^[39] USD/CAD approx. 1.3831 -- caught between Canada's weak August jobs (-41,700 vs +15,000 expected, widening the pair) and Canada's approx. \$27.6bn tariffs effective Tuesday (potentially CAD-supportive on trade-deficit reduction).^[40] EUR/USD 1.1613;^[41] GBP/USD 1.3507;^[41] USD/JPY 155.98, with BOJ hike risk adding downside pressure.^[41] USD/CNY 6.7093 (+0.02%), retreating from a 3-year high.^[39] Bitcoin approx. \$79,350-80,351 on Monday, holding above \$79,000.^[42]

Commodity / FX	Level	Change (vs Fri close)	Source
Brent crude	\$97.02/bbl	+0.76%	Trading Economics
WTI crude	\$92.63/bbl	+1.25%	Trading Economics
Gold	\$4,391.76/oz	-1.9%	Forbes Advisor
Silver	\$65.90/oz	-1.3%	FXStreet
Copper	\$6.56/lb	-0.5%	Trading Economics
Natural gas	\$2.97/MMBtu	-0.2%	Trading Economics
US diesel	\$5.9015/gal	Record high	AAA
US regular gas	\$4.15/gal	--	AAA
DXY	98.90	-0.28%	Trading Economics
EUR/USD	1.1613	--	FXStreet
USD/JPY	155.98	--	NordFX
GBP/USD	1.3507	--	FXStreet
USD/CAD	1.3831	--	SwingFish
Bitcoin	approx. \$79,350	approx. -2.4%	Yahoo Finance

5 Derivatives, volatility and positioning

VIX: Closed Friday at 14.53 (+1.45%), its 7th consecutive weekly decline and the bottom of its 2026 trading range.^[43] VIX3M 17.61; VVIX 84.42 (near multi-year lows, 1st percentile since start of 2025).^[44] VIX/VIX3M ratio 0.8251 -- contango, day 105 of current regime.^[45] A Yahoo Finance entry showing VIX at 15.22 on Sept 7 is an anomalous data artifact (markets were closed for Labor Day); the last confirmed cash close remains 14.53.

VIX futures term structure embeds a staircase of event risk: Sept VX 16.27 (settles 16 Sept AM, before the 2pm FOMC -- captures CPI but not the rate decision), Oct VX 18.14 (captures the FOMC outcome), Nov 18.77, Dec 18.98.^[46] The steepest step is Sept-to-Oct (+1.87 pts), pricing the FOMC outcome premium; spot-to-Sept (+1.74 pts) prices CPI. CPI-day straddle pricing at approx. 55bp is the lowest outside Dec 2024 and late-2021 prints.^[47]



Gamma: Dealers are net long gamma (all three third-party sources agree), with the zero-gamma flip at approx. 7,637-7,723; SPX at 7,718.60 sits just above the flip zone, meaning the long-gamma "shock absorber" is active but thin.^[13] Risk: approx. \$6.2 trillion in options expires through the 18 Sept triple witching (on pace to surpass June's record \$7.7T) -- the gamma cushion could dissolve as open interest rolls off.^[14]

Semi vol collapsed: top 15 SOX constituents' 1-month ATM IV fell to 46.0 from a peak of 77.2, down 40%; Russell 2000 1M ATM IV at 5-year lows; SPX 25-delta puts cheapest since December 2024.^[14]

Positioning: No new CFTC CoT data (last release: 1 Sept data, published 5 Sept; next: 12 Sept with 8 Sept data). Leveraged funds remain net short ES (-317,564), NQ (-18,034), and RTY (-109,499).^[48] SOFR: 3.66%, \$2.9T volume with 98% of transactions within a tight 3.60-3.74% range -- no funding stress.^[49]

6 The day ahead: Tuesday 8 September

Time (ET)	Event	Consensus / Detail
12:01am	Canada approx. \$27.6bn counter-tariffs take effect	700+ US products; steel/alum. 50%, dairy 25%, electronics 15%
6:00am	NFIB Small Business Optimism (Aug)	Cons. approx. 99.2 (prior 99.8) ^[50]
9:30am	US equity markets reopen	S&P futures flat at approx. 7,722
11:00am	NY Fed Survey of Consumer Expectations	--
3:00pm	Consumer Credit (Jul)	Cons. +\$12.0B (prior +\$14.17B) ^[51]
After close	GameStop Q2 earnings	See preliminary figures above

This week's known catalysts

Date	Event	Significance
Tue 8 Sept	Canada tariffs effective; NFIB; GameStop AH	First session with tariffs live; trade-exposed sectors (steel, aluminum) in focus
Wed 9 Sept	Apple iPhone 18 event; China CPI/PPI	First product launch under CEO Ternus; foldable iPhone debut
Thu 10 Sept	PPI (Aug); ECB decision; Oracle AH; Adobe AH	PPI as CPI preview; ECB expected +25bp; ORCL options imply +/-11.2%
Fri 11 Sept	CPI (Aug); UMich Sept prelim; Kroger	The decisive input for the 16 Sept FOMC coin-flip; Cleveland Fed nowcast approx. 3.45% y/y, prediction markets imply approx. 3.2-3.3% ^[52]
Tue 16 Sept	FOMC rate decision (2pm ET)	Hike vs hold; blackout period active since 5 Sept
Fri 18 Sept	Triple witching	Approx. \$6.2T in options expiring -- potentially record-breaking

Sector setup heading into the reopen

- **Energy:** Brent near \$97, WTI above \$92 on escalating Iran tanker war; Morgan Stanley flipped Shell to OW and TotalEnergies to EW -- a relative-value call within the sector. Diesel at record \$5.90/gal pressures transport margins.
- **Tech / AI capex:** Goldman Sachs Communacopia all week is the near-term catalyst factory; Nvidia near ATH (\$230.36 vs \$235.74 peak); Oracle's +/-11.2% implied move is below its recent average, suggesting options may be underpricing the risk.
- **Steel / aluminum:** Canada's 50% tariffs on US steel and aluminum take effect Tuesday -- watch Nucor (NUE), US Steel (X), Cleveland-Cliffs (CLF), Alcoa (AA).
- **Consumer discretionary:** Lululemon turnaround story begins with new CEO Tuesday; FICO's mortgage-scoring monopoly broken -- both multi-quarter structural shifts.
- **Rate-sensitive:** CPI Friday is the week's centerpiece; a 3.2-3.3% y/y print (per prediction-market implied median) would be a meaningful deceleration from July's 3.4% and could tilt September toward a hold.

Annex A: Data that could not be independently verified

VIX9D Friday 4 Sept close: edition 15 noted a fresh CBOE timestamp; this session could not reproduce the specific level (Yahoo 404, CNBC 403).

SKEW Friday 4 Sept close: Sept 3 value of 150.63 confirmed; Sept 4 value not found in any accessible source.

VIX6M Friday 4 Sept close: not directly confirmed; edition 14 logged 19.78 for Sept 3.

Yahoo VIX "Sept 7" entry at 15.22: anomalous -- markets were closed for Labor Day. Discarded as a data artifact.

CBOE daily put/call ratio: persistent unavailable.

MOVE index: RoboMacro showed 79.71 on Sept 2 (2 sessions stale); no fresh data.

OVX: stale feed snapshot only.

Official CME FedWatch probabilities: page blocks fetching; using Kalshi/Polymarket/futures-implied secondary citations instead.

Annex B: Sources

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[2] 24/7 Wall St -- "Bitcoin Jumped 5.12% to \$81,263.99" (247wallst.com, 3 Sept 2026); Fortune -- "Price of Bitcoin 09-03-2026" (fortune.com)

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[4] Trading Economics -- Brent crude oil (tradingeconomics.com/commodity/brent-crude-oil, 7 Sept 2026)

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[6] AAA -- Fuel prices (gasprices.aaa.com, 7 Sept 2026); ChooseEnergy -- Gas22 by state

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[8] Canada.ca -- Counter-tariff product list (finance.canada.ca, Aug 2026); Fasken -- "Canada's New Retaliatory Tariffs" (Aug 2026); GHY Trade Compliance

[9] defirate.com -- prediction-market aggregation (Kalshi / Polymarket, 7 Sept 2026); CentralBank.watch -- futures-implied (4 Sept 2026)

[10] Federal Reserve -- FOMC blackout period calendar PDF (federalreserve.gov/monetarypolicy/files/fomc-blackout-period-calendar.pdf); The National (6 Sept 2026)

[11] TipRanks -- Oracle options implied move (tipranks.com); Blockonomi -- Oracle earnings preview

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[13] ZeroGex.io -- SPX gamma levels (4 Sept 2026); FlashAlpha -- SPX GEX; SquawkFlow -- SPX GEX

[14] Citadel Securities -- "September Setup: The Asymmetry Has Changed" (citadelsecurities.com)

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17. [17] NordFX -- Market Pulse (7 Sept 2026)

18. [18] CNBC / Reuters -- "Anthropic IPO launch shifts toward mid-October" (5 Sept 2026); BraveNewCoin

19. [19] Cybernews -- "Google Ad Tech Breakup Antitrust" (Sept 2026)

20. [20] NVIDIA SEC filing nvda-20260902.htm (sec.gov); Yahoo Finance -- "NVDA Stock Moves Closer to ATH"

21. [21] BNN Bloomberg -- "New Lululemon CEO Faces Multifront Battle" (7 Sept 2026); TIKR -- "Lululemon Stock Crashed 17%"

22. [22] Yahoo Finance -- "Tesla Stock Drops 6%, Cybercab" (4 Sept 2026); CNBC -- NHTSA probe

23. [23] Yahoo Finance -- "One Regulator Just Ended FICO's Monopoly" (4 Sept 2026); BusinessWire / FHFA.gov

24. [24] EverHint -- Business news summaries (6-7 Sept 2026); GlobeNewswire -- SoundHound; BMO Newsroom

25. [25] GameStop IR -- Q2 2026 preliminary results (investor.gamestop.com); TipRanks -- GameStop earnings

26. [26] Yahoo Finance -- "Apple Sets iPhone Launch" (Sept 2026)

27. [27] Federal Reserve -- Governor Waller speech (federalreserve.gov/newsevents/speech/waller20260903a.htm, 3 Sept 2026)

28. [28] Federal Reserve -- Chair Warsh Jackson Hole keynote "In Our Time" (federalreserve.gov, 28 Aug 2026)

29. [29] Yahoo Finance -- "Trump Issues Ultimatum to Fed" (4 Sept 2026)

30. [30] Chase.com / JP Morgan -- September 2026 rate-hike analysis

31. [31] TastyFX -- Central Bank Watchlist September 2026

32. [32] Federal Reserve H.15 -- Selected Interest Rates (federalreserve.gov/releases/h15/, 3 Sept 2026 data)

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37. [37] FXStreet -- Silver price (fxstreet.com, 7 Sept 2026)

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39. [39] Trading Economics -- US Dollar Index, China Yuan (7 Sept 2026)

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42. [42] Yahoo Finance -- Bitcoin and Ethereum prices (7 Sept 2026)

43. [43] Yahoo Finance -- ^VIX historical data (finance.yahoo.com); Top Traders Unplugged -- Week in Review (4 Sept 2026)

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52. [52] Cleveland Fed inflation nowcast (via Yahoo Finance, 6 Aug 2026 vintage); Robinhood prediction market -- August CPI

53. [53] Stock Titan / Oracle IR -- Q1 FY2027 earnings date announcement

Method: Research via parallel domain-specific subagents (equities, macro, commodities/FX, derivatives), each using web search and direct source fetches. Dedicated verification pass on conflicting figures. Charts: matplotlib to PNG (dpi 210). PDF: HTML to Chromium print-to-PDF via Playwright. Edition 16 of a recurring daily briefing; spec and edition log maintained in the "Trading & Investments" project.